

Site 92: 19 – 19/52/1

Khirbet Malih (A), (SWP map: Kh. el-Maleh; Guérin: Kh. Tleilat el-Maleh, and in the modern map: Hamam el-Malih)

Israel grid: 1951 1928

UTM grid: 7337 5799

Elevation: 25 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: large ruin

Area: 13 dunams (3.3 acres)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa and Mediterranean brown forest soil; quality: 5

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: spring (‘Ain Malih, no. 87), next to site

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), passes by site

Visibility: 2

Jan. 27, 1983; Nov. 5, 1993; 35 shards

A complex of structures and ancient baths at the foot of a low hill in a valley, close to the gorge of Wadi

Malih.

On the western side of the site is a building with a row of rooms built



225. The *grotto* of Wadi and Hamam el-Malih, looking west. The hot springs are located near the palm trees; to their right were the baths. In the background is the hill of E.P. 174. Winter 1994.

of ashlar, and a plastered pool with a cistern east of it. On the northern bank of the wadi is a large structure dating to the Ottoman Period, used as a warm bath (Arab. *Hamam*). Behind and south of it are remains of other structures, while in front of it, northwards and in the part descending to the river, are a large courtyard and eucalyptus trees. 250 m to the east, near the river gorge, is a mill with an *aqueduct* leading to it. They also date to the Ottoman Period. Above the mill, on the mountain slope, is a ruined stone

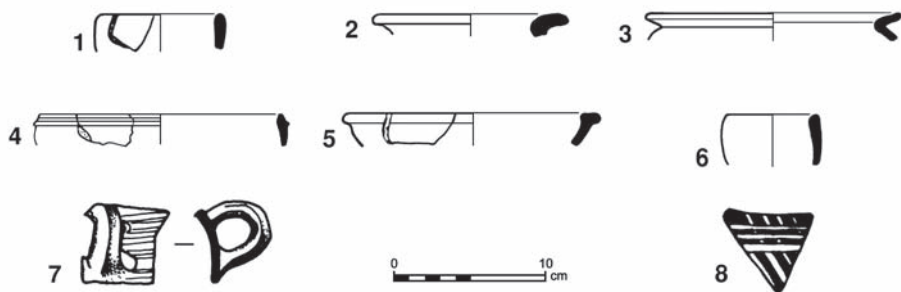
structure, probably used as a guard-house for the site. The site served as baths with hot water at least from the Roman Period onward.

Pottery: ER – 10%; Byz – 30%; EM – 20%; MA – 20%; Ott – 20%.

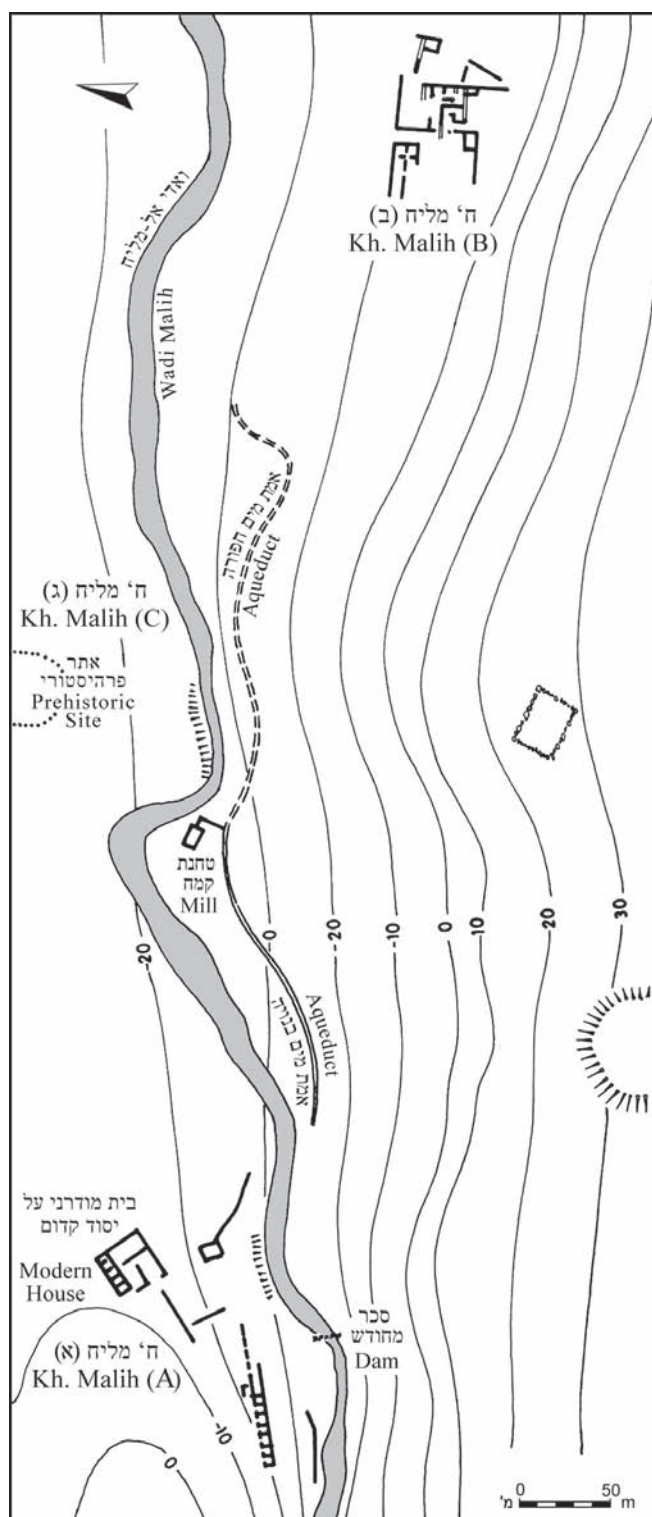
Guérin's suggestion that this site is *Abel Meholah* does not appear reasonable; see chapter three.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 84.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 275; SWP II, 239; Ozerman 1982.



226. Pottery from Hamam el-Malih: 1. Jug, lt br, ER; 2. Jar, lt, LR; 3. Bowl, lt, LR; 4. Bowl, dk, Byz; 5. Bowl, yel, EM; 6. Jug, br, Byz; 7. Jar handle, br, Byz; 8. Dec, wh on bl, Byz-EM.



227. The overall plan of the bath complexes in Hamam el-Malih. The plan shows the modern and ancient buildings of the site (Kh. Malih (A), below), the *aqueduct* and Ottoman Period flour mill (center), the tower (center right) and the prehistoric site (Kh. Malih (C), center left) and Kh. Malih (B) in the upper part.

Site 93: 19 – 19/52/2

Khirbet Malih (B)

Israel grid: 1959 1927

UTM grid: 7335 5799

Elevation: 25 m b.s.l., 35 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small ruin

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: ravine at the valley edge of wadi

Rock type: alluvium covering

Soil type: terra rossa, Mediterranean

brown forest soil and Colluvial – Alluvial; quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Nearest water source: river (Wadi Malih, no. 103), next to site

Nearest road: Tubas – Meholah (B8), 0.3 km distant

Visibility: 3

Feb. 29, 1988; 29 shards

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Well built structures on a small, artificial hill in a valley south of Wadi Malih, about 0.5 km east of Hamam el-Malih (Kh. Malih (A)).

A large complex of structures,

built according to a very strict plan, are found here. The masonry is good, of medium sized, hewn stones. The complex is bordered on the north by an enclosure wall. The inner plan contains rooms and



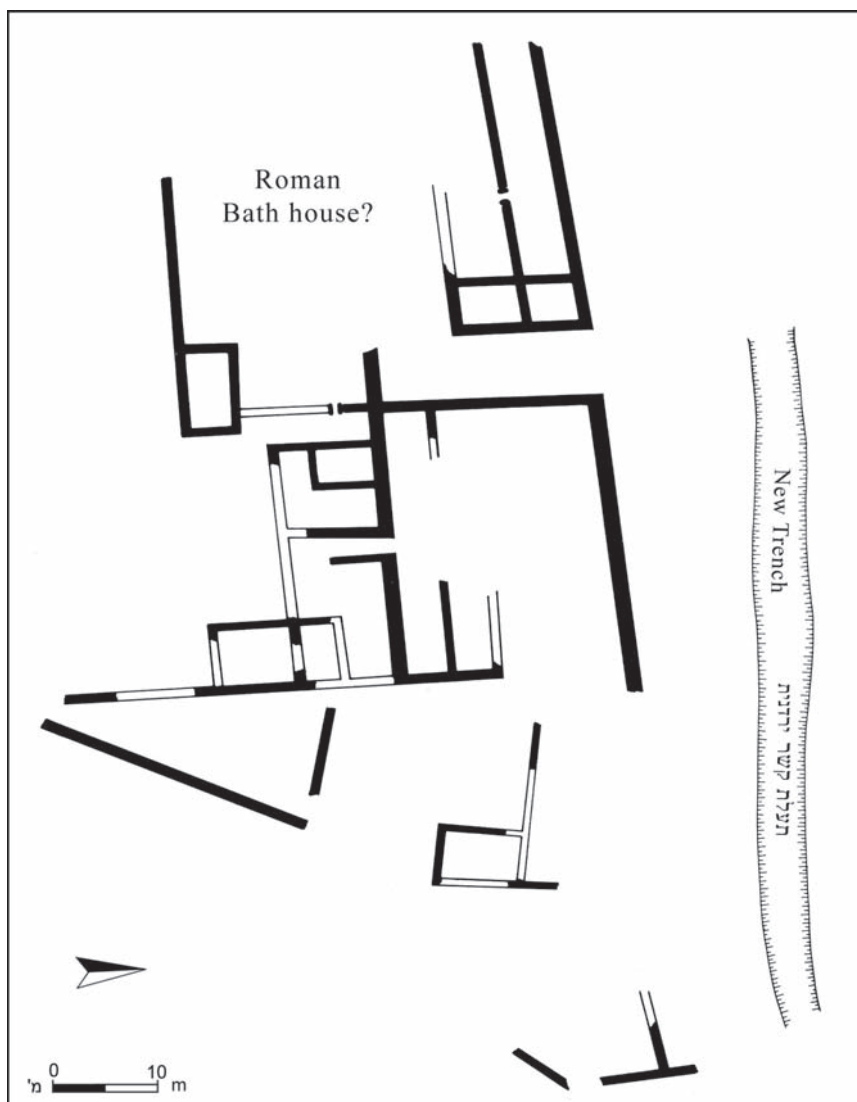
230. The site of Kh. Malih (B), looking north. The ruins are in the center of the valley, behind Wadi Malih. The road to the Jordan Valley runs through the distant part of the valley, while in the background are the ridges of Kh. Jabaris. Winter 1994.

possible streets or passageways. The western and southern parts of the place have been heavily damaged by bulldozers. In the northeast corner, hewn installations were found.

Pottery: LR – 40%; Byz – 50%; EM – 10%.

The site seems to be connected to the bath complexes of Hamam el-Malih. This was possibly an inn or commercial quarter for the visitors to the baths during the Roman-Byzantine Period.

Previous surveys: none.



229. Plan of Kh. Malih (B).